Report to The Portland Public Schools Board of Education

Date: April 29, 2026

From: Bond Accountability Committee

Subject: BAC Report #51

Committee Charge

The Portland Public Schools Board of Education (Board) has appointed a community Bond Accountability Committee ("Committee" or "BAC") whose charge is to monitor the planning and progress of the bond programs relative to voter-approved work scope, schedule, and budget objectives.

The duties of the Committee are (i) to receive reports on the status and planned implementation of the bond programs; (ii) to determine whether such status and implementation are consistent with the programs approved by the voters; and (iii) to report its findings to the Board.

The current members of the BAC are:
Greg DiLoreto, Chair
Norman Dowty
Chris Dunning
Travis George
Brian Harper
Ryan Kinsella
Chris Poulsen
Jonathan Truit
Cara Turano
Kelly Wingard
BOE Director Splitt, the BAC Liaison

Background:

In November 2012, voters approved a $482M capital improvement bond measure for Portland Public Schools. In May 2017, voters approved a $790M capital improvement bond measure. In November 2020, voters approved a $1.206B capital improvement bond measure, and in May 2025, voters approved a $1.8B capital improvement bond measure.

All BAC meetings are publicly noticed and open to the public. Staff presentation materials, along with BAC reports, are posted on the District website. Meetings are also

video recorded, which allows BAC members and the public unable to attend scheduled meetings to watch the proceedings and review the materials at their convenience.

This BAC meeting was held virtually on April 29, 2026. The BAC has a practice of alternating its meetings between in person and Zoom. In-person meetings have rotated among the various schools that have seen modernization or will see modernization. Since our last BAC meeting, three new members have been added to the BAC: Brian Harper, Chris Poulsen, and Kelly Wingard. Eight members participated in this meeting: Greg DiLoreto, Cara Turano, Kelly Wingard, Brian Harper, Chris Poulsen, Jonathan Truit, Norm Dowty, Chris Dunning and our BOE liaison Director Splitt. **The meeting focused on three main areas: A presentation on the structural engineering work developing the criteria and seismic improvements for PPS facilities; consolidated projects update; and an update on the ERP project. The BAC also recommended changes to its charter.**

The BAC received public comment from one individual concerning the use of bond funds for the improvements at the Grice-Adair Center.

Report

1. Whether the school district bond revenues are expended only for the purposes for which the bonds were approved, and that bond revenues are not used for any purpose prohibited by law.

- The BAC reviewed the Bond Program Administration report for the consolidated projects.
- **From the 2017 bonds, $165 million was allocated for consolidated projects of which $122 million has been spent in the areas of ADA, asbestos abatement, consolidated, fire systems, lead paint removal, radon, security improvements and water quality. From the 2020 bonds, $260 million has been allocated for consolidated projects, (which are all other types of projects that are NOT modernization/new school construction, such as life safety projects, IT projects, roofs, seismic, HVAC....smaller scale projects), capacity improvements, seismic, new roofs, mechanical including HVAC, ADA, and security improvements, of which $232 million has been spent.**
- All projects are reviewed by a designated PPS staff team to ensure that they meet the test of usability of bond funds, i.e., exceed a capital cost threshold and extend the life of the asset. **Based on these reports the BAC believes the programs to have been properly funded; it appears that the school district is spending revenues only for the purposes for which the bonds were approved.**

2. Whether the bond budget is sufficient to complete the scope of work as outlined in the voter-approved bonds.

- **As presented to the BAC there are sufficient funds to complete the scope of work as outlined in the voter-approved bonds.**
- Staff has nearly completed reconciling accounts and based on these reports, bond funds from the 2012 bond **are nearly 100% spent, the last, approximately, $350,000 available. Bond funds from the 2017 bonds are 95% spent of which $48.6 million is still available. Bond funds from the 2020 bonds are 59% spent with $542.5 million available**, **and only 6% of the 2025 bond funds have been spent**.
- **A total of $4.7 billion in bonds have been approved by the voters in 2012, 2017, 2020 and 2025 combined. To date 50% have been spent. Outstanding encumbrances are $182.6 million, and $2.3 billion in bond funds remain, the majority of which is in the 2025 bond.**
- **Staff believe that they are close to identifying the $100 million in funding to meet the objective funding for the seismic improvements noted in the 2025 bond.**

3. Whether the projects planned, in progress, and completed will meet the scope of work specified in the voter-approved bonds.

- The BAC received a presentation on the status of the seismic projects. All projects meet the scope of work specified in the voter-approved bonds. It was noted that seismic work is being conducted with the reroofing projects where appropriate, in addition to the seismic improvements on unreinforced masonry buildings.
- Consolidated projects for 2026 include:
    - 4 schools roofing with seismic
    - 3 schools with seismic parts improvements
    - Grant Bowl lighting
    - Marshal Track/field and Tennis Courts
    - Jackson Athletic Hub
    - 21 schools will get mechanical control systems
    - Fire alarm upgrades and multiple campuses.
- Curriculum
    - New Chromebooks for all PPS students
    - 41,500 devices will be deployed
- The BAC received an update on the ERP project. It is a complete reworking of the system.

- **Based on these reports the BAC believes the projects planned, in progress, and completed will meet the scope of work specified in the voter-approved bonds.**

4. Whether the projects are being delivered on schedule relative to the voter-approved bonds.

- As these are consolidated projects, they have various timelines. A series of projects will be completed this summer. Overall, the projects are scheduled for summer construction of 2026, 27, and 28. The ERP project is still on schedule; however, the risk noted to the BAC is that, with several unfilled administrative positions, this may slow down implementation of the ERP. **Based on the information presented, the projects are listed to be delivered on schedule, understanding that specific consolidated projects were not called out in the bond measure.**

5. The Committee will receive and review copies of annual performance audit reports and financial audit reports to ensure Bond revenues are expended in compliance with state law and the ballot measure language.

- **As noted in previous BAC reports, District staff is diligent in ensuring all bond revenues comply with state law and the ballot measure language, and the BAC has seen no evidence of operating outside of this compliance.** Portland Public Schools RISE and Finance Leadership staff review the proposed projects to verify that they fall within the requirements for capital projects for which bond funds may be used.

Additionally, the Committee may provide feedback and/or advice to the Board on one or more of the following topics:

- *Alignment with the goals and principles of the Long-Range Facilities Plan;*
- *Alignment with the goals of the Business Equity Policy;*
- *District standards and innovative practices for achieving lower maintenance and construction costs while improving operating efficiency, sustainability, and increasing building longevity;*
- *Historic preservation and school renovation opportunities compatible with the architecture of surrounding Portland neighborhoods;*
- *Potential capital partnerships for joint and shared use of PPS facilities;*
- *Implementation of appropriate ways to address seismic issues;*
- *Topics and scope for the annual performance audit work plan;*
- *Compliance with ADA; and*

- *Communicating key information related to the bonds to the School Board, public groups, organizations and stakeholders.*

- No additional items requiring feedback were discussed at this meeting.

- At the BAC January meeting we received a presentation from Janise Hansen of PPS regarding potential changes to the BAC charter. A special meeting of the BAC was held on April 8th where the Committee discussed those changes together with any changes the BAC wanted to make to the charter. Following that meeting, staff revised the proposed charter and that draft was presented at this BAC meeting. The BAC submits that draft to the Board for its consideration.

- *General Comments*

In conclusion, we continue to commend PPS with what they have accomplished as the number of projects is numerous and complex. Projects are coming in on time and generally within budget and scope. Procedeo has revised the reports to the BAC to reflect our comments from the previous meeting, and these reports meet the requirements the BAC needs to report to the BOE. We continue to appreciate the quality and professionalism of RISE staff, particularly as they work through the change in leadership. We thank the Board for this opportunity to serve and play a small part in the District's bond programs.